



Imaging Binesh Sreedharan

Money At The Gates

Have you ignored the prospect of sales on the Internet? Boost company profits—start selling online

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It's true that not all products are suitable for sale online. Not many online buyers would think, "Ahh, I'd like a ton of steel to build my own boat, and a couple of barrels of crude oil in case I run out of charcoal for the barbecue." However, if you are a medium-sized company offering products, and not services, you should already have an online retail outlet. If Fabmall.com can deliver groceries in Bangalore, there's no reason for any company to think twice about selling online.

As usual, basic questions abound: "Do people really buy online?", "We can't afford an online merchant ID, can we?", "Are my products too expensive/cheap to be sold online?", the list goes on... So let's take a look at why you should sell online before we get into telling you how to set up payment gateways.

Credit Cards And Impulse Buyers

Credit cards are such a novel invention. When used right, they can save you in times of cash crunches—while on the other hand, can be the cause for a cash crunch. As a business, credit cards are always your friends. The great fear of buying online with credit cards is reducing. More and more people are spending money they don't have, to buy things they don't really need—and most of it is online. As a business, if your products offer any sort of flaunt value, or have caused customers to impulse-buy, and you're not online yet, you're missing out on a lot of business.

Reputation And Appearance

It may sound shallow, but people are so used to seeing sites with shopping carts, coming across your site that does sell products, but not online, might make your company seem small. Whether this is true or not isn't really important; the fact is, you're not IBM or Microsoft, and you're not selling steel or crude oil. You